

adult male has
orange face and
enormous nose



Proboscis monkey

Nasalis larvatus

Proboscis monkeys are as complex as their facial features are unusual. Both sexes have exceptional noses. The females' and juveniles' noses are long for primates but upturned, while adult males sport the clownlike, pendulous proboscis that gives the species its common name. Its purpose is still uncertain, but it may function as an "echo chamber," amplifying the males' calls and helping them attract mates.

Deceptive appearance

Males are much larger than females. Due to the high volume of leaves they consume coupled with a very slow digestive rate, both sexes have large, swollen stomachs that make them look perpetually pregnant.

A mature male heads a harem of several females and their young. Unusually for primates, females in a harem compete with each other for mating opportunities with the male, and may join several harems during their lifetimes. As they mature, males form bachelor groups before vying for harems of their own. Although rival males engage in noisy displays, they are not fiercely territorial. Several groups often come together at dusk, sleeping high up in the trees for safety.

Proboscis monkeys are never far from water and they are remarkable swimmers, aided by their partially webbed feet.

An adult male's **nose** is often so long it has to be **pushed aside** to allow its owner **to eat**



△ ADOLESCENT SQUABBLE

Bonds are forged and broken as juveniles grow in size, get stronger, and learn new skills.



△ MIGHTY LEAP

Leaping from trees and belly flopping into water is a common activity. Proboscis monkeys can swim up to 65 ft (20 m) underwater when threatened.

◁ BABY FACE

Both sexes are born with a "normal" monkey nose, and black fur and blue faces. The nose grows and the coloration changes with age.